ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE E

Measure E would raise and expand Solano County's business license tax to include wind turbines, solar farms, battery storage systems, natural-gas extraction facilities, and data centers. While the measure is presented as a minor update that "generates approximately $353,000 annually," it is actually a new and permanent tax expansion on industries that already face regulation and infrastructure costs.

This tax increase directly affects small businesses that already struggle with rising costs. When business taxes go up, prices rise, and residents pay more for everyday goods and services, making daily life more expensive for ordinary families.

The County frames Measure E as a fairness adjustment, but the details tell a different story. The proposal raises the wind-energy rate by more than 160% and adds entirely new taxes on solar and battery facilities This discourages investment in clean-energy projects that create local jobs and long-term revenue.

The measure also adds a $5 sg ft tax on data centers, a rate higher than comparable counties. That could drive technology employers and energy developers to locate elsewhere, costing Solano County future economic growth. The projected $353,000 in annual revenue is modest, yet the potential loss of investment and jobs outweigh that gain.

Measure E includes automatic annual inflation increases and no sunset date. The tax lasts "until ended by voters." In reality, ending a tax requires a new ballot initiative and thousands of signatures collected, a process so difficult that most communities never succeed. Once enacted, these rates can quietly climb year after year without voter review.

Solano County should encourage responsible development, not layer new taxes on industries that power our economy and our future. Measure E is poorly timed, economically short-sighted, and inconsistent with California's renewable-energy goals.

Vote NO on Measure E.

Solano County Taxpayers Association
s/Michael T Nolan, President

s/ Shari Borkin
Dixon/Solano County resident